[INCH-POUND]
A-A-55481/5
September 18, 1995

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TAPE, VIDEO RECORDING, CASSETTE, HI-8 FORMAT, 8 MILLIMETER (MM) (0.314-INCH) WIDE, METAL PARTICLE (MP) POSITION, OR METAL EVAPORATED (ME) POSITION

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description (CID) for all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This CID covers the general requirements for a HI 8 format, 8 mm (0.314 inch) wide, MP position, or ME position video recording cassette tape. Video recording tapes covered by this CID are intended for commercial/industrial applications.

2. CLASSIFICATION. This CID uses a classification system which is included in the Part or Identification Number (PIN) as shown in the following example (see 6.1).

AA55481/5 - MP 030

CID PIN

Grade code (see table II)
(MP) for metal-particle tape position.
(ME) for metal-evaporated tape position.

Recording time code (see table I)

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

3.1 Design and construction. Video recording tapes supplied to this CID shall be as specified herein and shall meet the requirements of IEC 843-3.

3.2 Recording time code characteristics. The recording time code characteristics shall be as specified in table I.

3.3 Tape characteristics. Tape characteristics shall be as specified in table II.

TABLE I. Recording time code characteristics.

Recording time code	Cassette type	Recording time in standard play (SP) mode	Recording time in long play (LP) mode
030	P6-30 or E6-30	30 minutes	1 hour
060	P6-60 or E6-60	60 minutes	2 hours
120	P6-120 or E6-120	120 minutes	4 hours

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Defense Electronics Supply Center, ATTN: DESC-ELDM, 1507 Wilmington Pike, Dayton, OH 45444-5765, or telephone (513) 296-6189, or facsimile (FAX) (513) 296-8868.

AMSC N/A FSC 5836

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:48Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Tape characteristics.

		Grade code	
		Metal-particle grade (MP)	Metal-evaporated grade (ME)
Tape physical properties	Tape width	8.000 mm ±0.010 mm (.315 inch ±.0004)	
	Total tape thickness	9.0 micrometer (µm) minimum	
	Residual elongation	0.2 percent maximum	
	Yield strength	1.5 kilograms (kg) minimum	
Video performance	Radio frequency (RF) output at 7 megahertz (MHz) 1/	+2.0 dB minimum	+5.0 minimum
	Video signal-to-noise (S/N) 1/	+1.0 dB minimum	+2.5 dB minimum
	Color (S/N) 1/	+1.0 dB minimum	+1.0 dB minimum
	Stop motion	60 minutes minimum	
	Dropouts (maximum avg/min) 2/	less than 25	less than 25

1/ Compared to reference tape RSE-5001 as specified in IEC 1105.
2/ A dropout is defined as a 16 dB or greater loss in signal output for a period of 10 microseconds.

3.4 Used or reconditioned material. A manufacturer shall not furnish any video recording tape which is either used and reconditioned or is comprised of used or reconditioned material.

3.5 Marking. Video recording tapes supplied to this CID shall be marked with the Hi 8 logo and the manufacturer's standard commercial PIN.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS. Quality assurance provisions shall be as specified in A-A-55481.

5. PACKAGING. Packaging shall be as specified in A-A-55481.

6. NOTES

6.1 PIN. The PIN should be used for government purposes to buy commercial products to this CID. See section 2.1 for PIN format.

6.2 CAGE code. For ordering purposes, inventory control, and submission of these video recording cassette tapes to DESC under the Military Parts Control Advisory Group (MPCAG) evaluation program, CAGE code 58536 should be used.

6.3 Source of documents.

Commercial Item Description

A-A-55481 - Tape, Electronic Data Processing, Cartridge, General Specification for.

(Copies of commercial item descriptions are available from the Defense Printing Service Detachment Office, Building 4D (Customer Service), 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

Other Publications

INTERNATIONAL ELECTROTECHNICAL COMMISSION (IEC)

IEC 843-3 - Helical-scan video tape cassette systems using 8 mm video. High-band specifications for Hi 8.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:48Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

IEC 1105 - Reference tapes for video tape recorder systems.

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the International Electrotechnical Commission, 1 Rue De Varembe', Geneve, Switzerland.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

6.4 Government users. To acquire information on obtaining these video recording tapes from the Government inventory system, please contact Defense Electronics Supply Center, ATTN: DESC-EOC, 1507 Wilmington Pike, Dayton, OH 45444-5520, or telephone (513) 296-5625.

6.5 Suggested sources of supply. Suggested sources of supply are listed herein. Additional sources will be added as they become available.

CID dash number (see table I) AA55481/5-	Vendor commercial PIN CAGE 28091	Vendor commercial PIN CAGE 94961
MP030	288P6030	P6-30HXP
MP060	288P6060	P6-60HXP
MP120	288P6120	P6-120HXP
ME030	---	---
ME060	---	---
ME120	---	---

Vendor CAGE number	Vendor name and address
28091	Ampex Recording Media Corporation P.O. Box 190, Marvyn Parkway Opelika, AL 36803-0190 (205) 745-7643
94961	Minnesota Mining and Manufacturing Company 3M Audio and Video Products Division 3M Center St. Paul, MN 44144-1000 (612) 733-9697

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

GSA - KMR

Preparing Activity:

DLA - ES

Project 5836-D005-05

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:48Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.